

SKILLS GUIDE



Good communication skills across all forms of media, from social media to television.



The ability to work in a team on a variety of tasks, from making phone calls to handling mailings.



Great interpersonal skills and ability to manage negative responses appropriately.



Organizational skills to coordinate the work of untrained, but enthusiastic, volunteers.



Motivation and commitment to drive a fundraising project with limited funds and resources.



Financial knowledge and commercial awareness to work with business donors.



PLANNED GIVING

PROFESSIONAL Persuades and encourages a charity's supporters to leave part of their wealth to the charity in their wills. Legacies are an important source of income for most charities.



LOBBYIST Represents charities in meetings with politicians or government officials. Using their skills of persuasion, lobbyists encourage people to increase funding to the organization to help it achieve its aims.

AT A GLANCE



YOUR INTERESTS Fundraising • Planning • Psychology • Sociology • Politics • Journalism • Business studies • English • Economics



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS A relevant degree is useful, but hard work and commitment to the charity's causes may be sufficient to find a job.



LIFESTYLE Jobs can be part- or full-time. Weekend and evening work is common in roles that involve organizing events with the public.



LOCATION Much of the work is office-based, but fundraisers may need to visit potential donors, attend events, or organize street collections.



THE REALITIES Competition for jobs is intense when starting out, but experienced fundraisers can command high salaries.

RELATED CAREERS

► **MARKETING EXECUTIVE** *see pp. 68–69*

► **AID WORKER** Travels to countries affected by disaster, war, or poverty and helps the local people. Aid workers provide practical aid in medicine, education, or engineering, or coordinate the transportation and distribution of essential supplies, such as food or medicine.

